

Alienation

I will make a strong claim here in this essay, that modern world makes alienated from *others*, from *ourselves*, and from the *world around us*. This is a strong claim in which I will back up with my experience. Of course, I didn't come up with the idea, I'm just writing about my experience with it.

First, I'll need to define what being "alienated" means. Alienated is a marxist term, but I will define it for my own purposes. It's used to describe a specific *feeling* of being "separated" from the world around us. Abstracted.

I'd rather speak to *my* experience rather than be philosophical and haughty in trying to say *my* experience applies to all experiences. But, to quote Ralph Elliot:

Who knows but that, on the lower frequencies, I speak for you?

— Ralph Elliot

What does it feel like to be Alienated?

Imagine being in a room full of people. Or on a family dinner table with your parents. They are sitting right there, and yet they can't *see* you. Whatever you say to them they can't *hear* you because they are thinking about something else. Or being with yourself and yet you can't feel joy alone! You go on your phone trying to numb the feelings. Or you work and work and work, and yet you can not derive the joy from work because you are alienated from it! You don't care about the work you are doing. It sucks away your soul. You have no joy in your heart. If you've ever had the chance to read *Invisible Man* - it is that feeling that I'm trying to evoke in you.

Alienated from those around you

Parents

Alienated from yourself and your work

Alienated from the world itself